MODULAR ANNEX

ANNEX V.S.

Verification Sequencing Protocol

Step-by-Step IAEA Inspection, Verification, and Certification Timeline

IAEA-LED • NO UNANNOUNCED MILITARY ACCESS • MILESTONE-DRIVEN

Incorporated by reference into:
Memorandum of Understanding Pertaining to PEACE (v7.0)
and the Provisional Steps Framework (v1.8)

Version 1.0 — June 2026

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PREAMBLE

The International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) has not had full access to certain Iranian nuclear facilities for an extended period. Structural damage from military strikes affects the integrity of HEU storage cylinders and the accessibility of declared sites. The United States has called for a clear, sequenced plan specifying when inspectors enter, what they check, and how compliance is certified.

This Annex establishes a phased, milestone-driven verification protocol that aligns with the 60-Day Reciprocal Sequencing Schedule (Annex S) and the IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol (Annex O). The IAEA leads all verification activities; the United States does not receive direct, unannounced access. Iran retains sovereignty over its facilities while providing IAEA inspectors the access necessary to verify compliance.

All obligations execute in the active present tense. Step-back and earn-back follow MOU Article 7.3.

Modularity Clause

This Annex V.S. is self-contained and incorporates into the Memorandum of Understanding Pertaining to PEACE and the Provisional Steps Framework by the sentence of adoption in Part D-1 of the MOU. It does not amend or supersede conflicting provisions of any parent framework unless the Parties explicitly so agree. In the event of inconsistency, this Annex V.S. governs with respect to the sequencing of IAEA inspector deployment, inspection scope and checkpoints, compliance certification gates, and integration with the 60-Day Reciprocal Sequencing Schedule.

ARTICLE 1: PHASED INSPECTOR DEPLOYMENT AND ACCESS

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

1.1 Pre-Entry Phase (Days 1–7)

The Pre-Entry Phase establishes the operational foundation for all subsequent verification activities. IAEA inspectors deploy to Iran, receive safety briefings, conduct joint walkthroughs, install baseline monitoring equipment, and issue the Preliminary Access Report that certifies facility readiness for full inspection operations.

Day	IAEA Activity	Iranian Obligation	Verification Output
1	IAEA submits final inspector roster to Iran	Iran approves visas within 48 hours (per Annex O, Article 1.3)	Roster confirmation
2	IAEA advance team arrives at Tehran airport; receives safety briefing	Iranian facility directors notified; hazard maps provided	Travel log; briefing acknowledgment
3	Joint safety walkthrough at first priority facility (Esfahan)	IAEA inspectors and Iranian officers jointly assess hazards	Signed walkthrough report
4	IAEA deploys initial monitoring equipment at Esfahan	Iran provides access to cylinder storage areas	Equipment installation log
5	IAEA begins baseline gamma spectroscopy of accessible cylinders	Iranian technicians operate equipment under IAEA supervision	Baseline spectral data
6	Equipment calibration and verification; second facility walkthrough (Natanz)	Iran provides Natanz access; confirms site readiness	Calibration certificate; Natanz walkthrough report
7	IAEA issues Preliminary Access Report	Iran confirms all Tier 1 facilities accessible	Report filed with PCC Secretariat

1.2 Full Inspection Phase (Days 8–30)

The Full Inspection Phase covers the systematic physical inventory, non-destructive assay, and environmental sampling of all HEU storage cylinders and declared facilities. IAEA inspectors work with Iranian technicians to verify material presence, assess damage, and establish the baseline for all subsequent certification.

Week	IAEA Activity	Iranian Obligation	Verification Output

Week 2 (Days 8–14)	Physical inventory of all Category I (intact) cylinders at Natanz and Fordow	Provide cylinder location records; escort inspectors; operate lifting equipment	25% cylinder verification certificate
Week 3 (Days 15–21)	Non-destructive assay (NDA) of Category II-A cylinders (minor damage) at all declared sites	Clear debris for cylinder access; joint NDA measurements; provide damage documentation	Damage classification report
Week 4 (Days 22–28)	Environmental sampling at all declared storage areas; remote sensing setup	Provide swipe samples; witness sealing; permit drone staging	Environmental analysis report; remote sensing readiness certificate
Week 4 cont.	Fordow deep-tunnel assessment; inventory of cylinders in underground storage	Provide tunnel access; ventilation assurance; emergency egress briefing	Fordow inventory certificate

1.3 Advanced Verification Phase (Days 31–60)

The Advanced Verification Phase transitions from initial inventory to sustained compliance monitoring. Remote sensing, continuous monitoring installation, and interim compliance certification demonstrate that Iran maintains its obligations over the full 60-day window.

Week	IAEA Activity	Iranian Obligation	Verification Output
Week 5 (Days 29–35)	Remote sensing survey of Category II-B and III sites (drones, UGVs); continuous monitoring installation begins	Permit drone overflight and ground robot access; provide power and network for encrypted feeds	Remote sensing imagery; 50% verification certificate
Week 6 (Days 36–42)	Install continuous monitoring cameras and tamper-evident seals at all breakout-relevant facilities; mid-point review	Provide power and network access; verify seal integrity protocols	Monitoring installation certificate
Week 7 (Days 43–49)	Comprehensive data review; cross-check all inventory, NDA, and environmental data; IAEA issues Interim Compliance Certification (Day 45)	Confirm no enrichment above 3.67% for 45 consecutive days; provide operational records	Interim Compliance Certificate (Day 45)
Week 8 (Days 50–60)	Final verification sweep; confirm all certification criteria met; IAEA issues Full 60-Day Compliance Certification	Demonstrate sustained compliance; confirm no material unaccounted for; provide final operational declaration	Full 60-Day Compliance Certificate

ARTICLE 2: INSPECTION SCOPE AND CHECKPOINTS

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

2.1 What Inspectors Check (by Facility Type)

The IAEA conducts facility-specific inspection activities according to the following schedule. Each activity is tailored to the facility type, its damage status, and its relevance to HEU stockpile verification.

Facility Type	Inspection Activity	Frequency	Verification Method
Enrichment sites (Natanz, Fordow)	Cascade hall monitoring; cylinder inventory; enrichment level verification; UF6 feed and product monitoring	Weekly	OLEM monitors; swipe sampling; gamma spectroscopy; mass spectrometry
Storage areas (Esfahan)	Cylinder identity verification; tamper-evident seal integrity; environmental sampling; temperature and pressure monitoring	Bi-weekly	Seal verification; swipe analysis; radiological assay; chain-of-custody documentation
Damaged sites (per Annex O)	Remote sensing (drones/UGVs); debris sampling; radiation mapping; structural stability assessment	Monthly	Imagery analysis; isotopic assay; telemetry review; engineering assessment
Heavy water reactor (Arak)	Reactor operability assessment; moderator sampling; calandria inspection; heavy water inventory verification	Quarterly (until conversion complete)	IAEA inspection report; moderator analysis; photographic documentation
Conversion facilities (Isfahan UCF)	UF6 production monitoring; feedstock verification; product cylinder sealing	Monthly	Material balance verification; cylinder tracking; seal inspection

2.2 Challenge Inspection Protocol

If the IAEA identifies a discrepancy or receives a credible allegation of non-compliance, the following protocol applies:

- The IAEA notifies Iran within 4 hours of discrepancy identification.
- Iran has 24 hours to provide clarifying information or remedy the discrepancy.
- If the discrepancy remains unresolved, the IAEA requests managed access to a specific location (not open-ended "anywhere, anytime").
- Managed access is limited to the area necessary to resolve the discrepancy, with Iranian escorts present at all times.
- Refusal of managed access triggers a Tier 2 material disruption under MOU Article 7.3.

The challenge inspection protocol respects Iran's sovereignty while ensuring the IAEA retains the operational tools necessary to resolve genuine compliance concerns. The framework architecture excludes open-ended access demands.

2.3 No Unannounced Military Access

The United States does not receive direct, unannounced access to Iranian facilities. All inspection access possesses the following characteristics:

- **IAEA-led:** Only IAEA inspectors conduct physical inspections. U.S. personnel observe through IAEA reporting and live video feeds, not through direct facility access.
- **Scheduled with advance notification:** All routine inspections are scheduled at least 48 hours in advance through the PCC Secretariat, except challenge inspections under Article 2.2.
- **Limited to declared facilities:** Inspection scope extends only to declared nuclear facilities and locations relevant to HEU stockpile verification.
- **Iranian personnel present:** AEOI officials or designated Iranian technicians escort all IAEA inspectors during facility access.

ARTICLE 3: COMPLIANCE CERTIFICATION GATES

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

3.1 Certification Levels and Triggers

Each compliance certification constitutes a verified milestone that unlocks specific economic relief measures under Annex S and MOU Article 5. The IAEA issues certificates based solely on technical verification, not political judgment.

Certificate	Issuing Authority	Trigger	Consequence
Baseline Inventory Certificate	IAEA	Completion of initial inventory and Preliminary Access Report (Day 7–14)	Releases first escrow tranche ($500M) per MOU Article 5
25% Verification Certificate	IAEA	Physical verification of 25% of declared HEU cylinders as intact (Day 14)	Triggers Week 2 economic relief under Annex S
Damage Classification Certificate	IAEA	Completion of NDA for all Category II-A cylinders (Day 21)	Enables downblending pathway selection; opens structural relief track
30-Day Compliance Certificate	IAEA	30 consecutive days of verified compliance with zero Tier 2/3 violations (Day 30)	Triggers Tranche 1 of frozen assets (15% cumulative release)
Disposition Milestone Certificate	IAEA	First verified 50% reduction of 60% HEU through downblending or export (Day 45–60)	Opens good-faith fast lane; converts structural relief to normalized trade
Interim Compliance Certificate	IAEA	45 consecutive days of clean telemetry, inspection results, and no enrichment above 3.67% (Day 45)	Accelerates Phase II preparation; signals sustained compliance
Full 60-Day Compliance Certificate	IAEA	60 consecutive days of clean telemetry, inspection results, and full inventory verification (Day 60)	Full Phase I verification complete; Phase II negotiations commence
Quarterly Certification	IAEA	Every 90 days thereafter with continuous monitoring data review	Maintains economic relief tranches; prevents step-back reversion

3.2 Certificate Issuance Procedure

The IAEA follows a standardized procedure for issuing all compliance certificates:

- The IAEA inspection team submits a draft certificate to IAEA Vienna within 24 hours of milestone completion.

- IAEA Vienna reviews the draft and either confirms the certificate or requests additional verification data.
- Upon confirmation, the IAEA Director General signs the certificate and transmits it to: the Islamic Republic of Iran (AEOI); the United States (via diplomatic channel); and the PCC Secretariat (Geneva) for logging in the Shared Digital Registry.
- The certificate is presumptively correct — rebuttable only by clear and convincing evidence of material error.
- The Swiss facilitator receives a copy of each certificate and executes the corresponding tranche release within 24 hours of certificate transmission.

3.3 Disputed Certificates

If Iran challenges a certificate's factual accuracy, the following dispute resolution procedure applies:

- Iran files a notice of dispute with the PCC within 7 days of certificate issuance.
- The PCC convenes a technical review panel comprising IAEA technical staff plus one representative each from Iran and the United States.
- The panel issues a non-binding recommendation within 14 days.
- If the dispute persists, the matter proceeds to binding arbitration under Annex O, Article 6 (expedited 5–7 day timeline).
- Pending resolution, the certificate remains in effect unless the panel orders a temporary suspension.
- No escrow tranche is held pending dispute resolution unless the panel specifically orders a suspension. Tranches release on schedule; any clawback occurs only if arbitration reverses the certification.

ARTICLE 4: INTEGRATION WITH ANNEX S (60-DAY SCHEDULE)

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

This Annex V.S. provides the verification details that Annex S assumes. The following table maps each week of the Annex S schedule to the corresponding verification activity and certificate under this Annex V.S.

Annex S Week	Corresponding Verification Activity	Certificate
Week 1 (Days 1–7)	IAEA inspector deployment; visa approval; safety walkthrough; equipment installation; Preliminary Access Report	Baseline Inventory Certificate
Week 2 (Days 8–14)	Physical inventory of Category I cylinders at Natanz and Fordow; 25% verification	25% Verification Certificate
Week 3 (Days 15–21)	NDA of Category II-A cylinders; damage classification; environmental sampling	Damage Classification Certificate
Week 4 (Days 22–28)	Continued NDA; remote sensing setup; Fordow tunnel assessment; downblending preparation	50% Verification Certificate
Week 5 (Days 29–35)	Remote sensing survey; continuous monitoring installation; mid-point data review	Monitoring Installation Certificate
Week 6 (Days 36–42)	Comprehensive data cross-check; all breakout-relevant facilities under monitoring; 75% verification	75% Verification Certificate
Week 7 (Days 43–49)	Interim Compliance Certification (Day 45); final verification sweep preparation	Interim Compliance Certificate
Week 8 (Days 50–60)	Final verification sweep; full 60-day compliance certification; Phase II transition	Full 60-Day Compliance Certificate

Cross-reference: For the full reciprocal pairing of economic relief measures with verification milestones, see Annex S, Article 2. For the financial micro-tranche release schedule, see Annex S, Article 3 and MOU Article 5.

ARTICLE 5: RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER ANNEXES

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

Annex / Provision	Relationship
Annex S (60-Day Reciprocal Sequencing)	This Annex V.S. provides the verification details and certification gates that Annex S's economic relief pairings assume.
Annex O (IAEA Access and Site Integrity)	This Annex V.S. sets the operational timeline for the access rights and inspection procedures established in Annex O.
MOU Article 7.3 (Step-Back/Earn-Back)	Failure to meet verification milestones or refusal of managed access triggers Tier 2 material disruption under the MOU's step-back architecture.
Annex H (Mutual Safety Hold)	Safety-related access delays at damaged facilities invoke Annex H's 14-day safety hold mechanism, which suspends the Annex V.S. timeline for the affected facility only.
Annex V (Nuclear Dust Protocol)	Damaged site verification follows Annex V protocols for extraction and remediation, while Annex V.S. governs the IAEA inspection and certification sequencing.
Annex Q (IRGC Access Compliance)	Post-14-day access denials at IRGC-controlled facilities invoke Annex Q's classification and expedited dispute resolution mechanisms.

5.1 Distinction from Annex V (Nuclear Dust Protocol)

Annex V (Nuclear Dust Protocol) governs the physical extraction and remediation of Nuclear Dust from collapsed military engineering sites. Annex V.S. governs the verification sequencing for all declared nuclear facilities, including those damaged by military strikes. Where a facility is both a declared nuclear site and a Nuclear Dust site, Annex V governs the extraction operation and Annex V.S. governs the IAEA inspection and certification sequencing. The two annexes operate in parallel, not in sequence.

5.2 Distinction from Annex V-R (Verification Restoration Protocol)

Annex V-R establishes the pre-signature baseline inventory of declared facilities before MOU entry into force. Annex V.S. operates after MOU entry into force, providing the ongoing verification sequencing for the 60-day window and beyond. Annex V-R is a one-time pre-signature assessment; Annex V.S. is a continuous 60-day (and quarterly) verification architecture.

ARTICLE 6: INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

This Annex V.S. incorporates into the Memorandum of Understanding Pertaining to PEACE and the Provisional Steps Framework by the following sentence of adoption:

> *"The Parties adopt Annex V.S. (Verification Sequencing Protocol) as an operative provision of this Agreement. This Annex establishes a step-by-step timeline for IAEA inspector entry, inspection scope, and compliance certification, consistent with the 60-Day Reciprocal Sequencing Schedule (Annex S) and the IAEA Access and Site Integrity Protocol (Annex O)."*

No amendment of the parent MOU is required. This Annex enters into force upon signature by both Parties or provisional application by exchange of diplomatic notes.

ARTICLE 7: PROVISIONAL APPLICATION

OPERATIVE AND BINDING

The Parties apply this Annex V.S. provisionally for 90 days, pending formal incorporation. Exchange of diplomatic notes between the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran effects provisional application, with notification to the PCC Secretariat.

During provisional application, all provisions of this Annex V.S. are operative and binding.

Either Party terminates provisional application with 14 days' written notice. Termination does not affect: IAEA inspections already completed; certificates already issued; tranches already released; or verification data already collected.

SIGNATURE BLOCK

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name:

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Title:

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Date:

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For the United States of America:

Name:

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Title:

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Date:

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For the International Atomic Energy Agency (as verification authority):

Name: Rafael Mariano Grossi, Director General

Date: ____